

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting contested proceedings, case preparation and hearing materials at BCLP, and advising clients on complex legal matters at Citizens Advice. Experienced in reviewing and organising evidence, preparing hearing bundles, drafting procedural documents and managing case files across multiple matters under pressure. Strong legal research and written communication skills. Particular interest in regulatory proceedings, professional standards and public protection.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Specialist modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Interviews clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps; researches complex points of law
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex statutory rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration through to a significant procedural deadline: reviewed and organised evidence for submissions and the Claimant's memorial, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and amended sections of the memorial
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before the submission deadline; coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time filing
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Assisted with hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles, and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Maintained matter records via iManage; prepared client notes

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; document review; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundles, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters